

ENDICOTT COLLEGE · GERRISH SCHOOL OF BUSINESS

BUS210 Finance

Fall 2026 Course Syllabus

Monday/Wednesday/Friday · 50 minutes



Course Snapshot

COURSE BUS210 Finance · 3 credits · Lecture	SECTION TBA
MEETING PATTERN Monday, Wednesday, and Friday · 50 minutes	TIME / ROOM TBA · Confirm in Registrar schedule and Canvas
INSTRUCTOR Professor Bethany Evitts, CFA	OFFICE Gerrish School of Business 356
EMAIL bevitts@endicott.edu	OFFICE HOURS Use the live appointment calendar

How We Learn Finance

Each class follows a practical cycle. Exact assignments and due times appear in Canvas.

1 PREPARE Read or watch, then arrive with the workbook ready.	2 PRACTICE Model the decision in Excel and explain what the result means.	3 PROVE Complete a quiz, case, checkpoint, or exam independently.
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Your Finance Learning Journey

1 Value money PV · FV · loans	2 Read markets rates · institutions	3 Value debt bonds · mortgages	4 Value equity stocks · risk · CAPM	5 Choose projects WACC · NPV · IRR
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Course Purpose and Learning

Catalog Description

An introduction to finance including organization, taxes, capital markets, the commercial banking system, interest rates, financial analysis, financial forecasting, working capital management, marketable securities, accounts receivable, inventories, and short-term credit instruments. Students will use Excel to apply concepts.

Prerequisite: ACC 175.

Learning Outcomes

The source course goal is to understand key principles in finance and, through practical problem solving, appreciate the link between theory and practice. By the end of the course, students should be able to:

- Use cash-flow timelines, financial mathematics, and Excel to solve time-value-of-money decisions.
- Explain how financial markets, institutions, interest rates, and risk connect savers, borrowers, and firms.
- Value bonds, mortgage cash flows, and common stock using appropriate assumptions and models.
- Measure return and risk, explain diversification, and estimate required return using CAPM.
- Estimate the cost of capital and evaluate investments using NPV, IRR, and sound financial judgment.

Teaching and Learning Strategy

Class combines concise instruction with active Excel-based exercises, worked examples, discussion, retrieval practice, and independent assessment. Students are expected to complete assigned preparation before class and bring the correct files to every meeting.

Required Reading, Technology, and Files

- Finance: Applications and Theory by Cornett, Adair, and Nofsinger through McGraw Hill Connect (use the edition and access instructions posted in Canvas).
- Endicott Microsoft 365 access and the desktop version of Microsoft Excel installed on a PC laptop.
- Ability to save, organize, upload, and download Excel files without changing required filenames or formats.
- A financial calculator or approved calculator method when directed, plus LockDown Browser for quizzes and exams.

Bring to class: Your charged laptop, the assigned Excel workbook, and a way to take notes. Back up important files before class.

Evaluation and Grading

Your course grade is based on the following components. Canvas shows the assignment-level details and current scores.

Evaluation component	Weight
Class participation: attendance, preparation, contribution, and professional engagement	5%
Readings / SmartBook activities	5%
Homework problems and Excel practice (completion-based unless Canvas states otherwise)	5%
Quizzes (lowest quiz score dropped)	20%
Three unit exams	50%
Comprehensive final exam	15%

Make-up assessments: Except in verified extreme circumstances, make-ups are not permitted. If a make-up is approved, it must be completed no later than one week after the scheduled assessment unless the professor approves a different arrangement in writing.

Official Grading Scale

A	94-100	B-	80-83	D+	67-69
A-	90-93	C+	77-79	D	64-66
B+	87-89	C	74-76	D-	60-63
B	84-86	C-	70-73	F	Below 60

WX indicates withdrawn failed when assigned under College policy.

Course Expectations and Policies

Attendance and Participation

Students are expected to attend every scheduled 50-minute class, arrive prepared, and participate professionally. More than one unexcused absence will reduce the attendance and participation grade. Six unexcused absences may result in a request for withdrawal. Approved accommodations and verified absences will be handled through the appropriate College process.

Workload, Communication, and Canvas

For each credit hour, students should plan for at least two hours of work outside class each week. For this three-credit course, that means at least six hours weekly. Check Canvas at least once per day for announcements, assignments, files, and schedule adjustments. Canvas due dates take precedence over the planning notes in the tentative schedule.

Review the [Endicott undergraduate academic calendar](#) and plan to remain available through the scheduled final-exam period.

Academic Integrity

Students must follow Endicott College's Academic Integrity Policy. Work submitted for assessment must be your own unless collaboration is explicitly authorized. Plagiarism, copying prior submissions, unauthorized collaboration, sharing assessment content, falsification, and other cheating are serious violations. Course violations may result in a failing course grade and will be reported through the College process.

Proper paraphrasing means reading, thinking, interpreting, and then writing in your own words while acknowledging the source. Changing only a few words from a source is not proper paraphrasing. Ask for help before submitting work if you are unsure.

Artificial Intelligence and LockDown Browser

AI tools or AI-assisted software are prohibited for graded work unless Professor Evitts explicitly permits a specific use in the assignment instructions. When AI use is permitted, students must follow the stated tool, disclosure, citation, and privacy requirements. Misrepresentation of AI-generated work as one's own is academic dishonesty. LockDown Browser will be used for quizzes and exams; students are responsible for installing and testing it before an assessment.

Read Endicott's current [guidance for using AI](#). Do not upload non-public institutional information, student work, or personally identifiable information to public AI tools.

Turnitin

Required assignments may be submitted to Turnitin for similarity review. The tool can help identify passages that are unoriginal, incorrectly cited, or missing source information. Submissions may be retained in Turnitin's database for future similarity comparisons and other educational purposes at the instructor's discretion.

[Review Turnitin's privacy information](#) for additional details.

Religious Observances

Notify the professor within the first two weeks of the semester about specific dates on which you request relief for religious observance so that an appropriate plan can be made.

Subject to Change

This syllabus states the course objectives and the best estimate of what the class will cover. The professor may adjust the sequence, assignments, or schedule to respond to student learning needs, College changes, or unforeseen circumstances. Any change will be announced in Canvas.

Student Support

Accessibility Students requesting accommodations should connect with the Center for Accessibility Services. General inquiries: access@endicott.edu. Open current resource	Academic success Free content and writing tutoring, advising, and academic-support services are available through the Division of Academic Success. Open current resource	Professor support Use office hours early. Bring the problem, workbook, or concept you want to work through. Open current resource
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Pregnancy and Parental Status

Endicott does not discriminate based on pregnancy, parental status, or related medical conditions. Qualified students may be eligible for academic adjustments that support continued participation in the course.

For current contacts and procedures, visit [Endicott Title IX](#).

Fall 2026 Tentative Schedule - Monday/Wednesday/Friday - 50 minutes

Schedule assumptions: The dates use the requested meeting pattern. Exact section, clock time, room, final-exam appointment, assignment due times, and any later changes must be confirmed in the Registrar schedule and Canvas.

Week	Date	Unit	Focus	In-class work	Prepare / submit
1	Wed, Sep 2	Orientation	Course launch: what finance helps us decide	Canvas tour, decision warm-up, baseline check	Complete Start Here; activate Connect; skim Ch. 1
1	Fri, Sep 4	Foundations	Excel readiness and financial-statement review	Workbook setup, formulas, references, and model habits	Complete Excel readiness practice; read Ch. 4
2	Sep. 7	<i>Labor Day observed - no class</i>			
2	Wed, Sep 9	TVM	Single-sum present and future value	Cash-flow timelines; solve PV and FV	Complete Ch. 4 practice I
2	Fri, Sep 11	TVM	Single-sum TVM in Excel	Build and audit a PV/FV model	Complete Excel checkpoint
3	Mon, Sep 14	TVM	Rates and periods	Solve for RATE and NPER; interpret results	Complete Ch. 4 practice II
3	Wed, Sep 16	TVM	Single-sum concept check	Quiz, corrections, and transfer problem	Read Ch. 5
3	Fri, Sep 18	TVM	Annuities	Compare ordinary annuities and annuities due	Complete Ch. 5 practice I
4	Mon, Sep 21	TVM	Annuities in Excel	Model payment streams with PV, FV, and PMT	Submit TVM workbook checkpoint
4	Wed, Sep 23	TVM	Loans and credit cards	Analyze payments, balances, and borrowing cost	Complete Ch. 5 practice II
4	Fri, Sep 25	TVM	Retirement and 401(k) decisions	Savings scenario and decision memo	Complete Ch. 5 quiz
5	Mon, Sep 28	TVM	TVM review	Mixed practice, retrieval, and misconception check	Study for the TVM exam
5	Wed, Sep 30	Assessment	TVM exam	Exam	Read Ch. 6
5	Fri, Oct 2	Markets	Financial markets and institutions	Trace capital flows and interest-rate signals	Complete Ch. 6 quiz; read Ch. 7
6	Mon, Oct 5	Fixed Income	Exam debrief and bond cash flows	Correct problem areas; map coupon and principal cash flows	Complete Ch. 7 practice I
6	Wed, Oct 7	Fixed Income	Bond prices	Value coupon and zero-coupon bonds	Complete bond price problems
6	Fri, Oct 9	Fixed Income	Excel bond valuation	Build and audit a bond valuation model	Submit bond workbook checkpoint
7	Oct. 12	<i>Indigenous Peoples/Columbus Day observed - no class</i>			
7	Wed, Oct 14	Fixed Income	Bond yields	Calculate and interpret yield to maturity	Complete Ch. 7 practice II
7	Fri, Oct 16	Fixed Income	Interest-rate risk	Test maturity, coupon, and rate sensitivity	Complete rate-risk questions
8	Mon, Oct 19	Fixed Income	Credit risk and ratings	Compare issuer risk and rating evidence	Complete Ch. 7 quiz I

Week	Date	Unit	Focus	In-class work	Prepare / submit
8	Wed, Oct 21	Mortgages	Mortgage structure	Identify payment, principal, interest, and term	Complete mortgage practice I
8	Fri, Oct 23	Mortgages	Excel amortization	Build and check an amortization schedule	Submit amortization checkpoint
9	Mon, Oct 26	Mortgages	Refinancing decision	Calculate breakeven and compare alternatives	Complete mortgage case
9	Wed, Oct 28	Fixed Income	Bond and mortgage review	Integrated practice and exam strategy	Study for the bond and mortgage exam
9	Fri, Oct 30	Assessment	Bond and mortgage exam	Exam	Read Ch. 8
10	Mon, Nov 2	Equity	Exam debrief and stock valuation basics	Correct problem areas; map equity cash flows	Complete Ch. 8 practice I
10	Wed, Nov 4	Equity	Dividend discount model	Connect return, growth, dividends, and value	Complete DDM problems
10	Fri, Nov 6	Equity	Stock valuation in Excel	Build a scenario model and sensitivity table	Submit stock workbook checkpoint
11	Mon, Nov 9	Risk & Return	Holding-period returns	Calculate total return across scenarios	Complete Ch. 9 practice I
11	Wed, Nov 11	Risk & Return	Risk and dispersion	Calculate variance and standard deviation	Complete Ch. 9 practice II
11	Fri, Nov 13	Risk & Return	Portfolio risk	Explore diversification and correlation	Complete Ch. 9 quiz
12	Mon, Nov 16	Risk & Return	Capital Asset Pricing Model	Estimate required return with beta and market risk premium	Complete Ch. 10 practice I
12	Wed, Nov 18	Risk & Return	Estimating risk and return in Excel	Analyze historical data and regression intuition	Submit risk-and-return workbook
12	Fri, Nov 20	Equity	Integrated equity case	Combine valuation, risk, and return evidence	Complete Ch. 10 quiz
13	Nov. 23-27	Thanksgiving recess - no class			
14	Mon, Nov 30	Equity	Stock and risk unit review	Mixed practice, retrieval, and misconception check	Study for the stock and risk exam
14	Wed, Dec 2	Assessment	Stock and risk exam	Exam	Read Ch. 11
14	Fri, Dec 4	Capital Decisions	Cost of capital and WACC	Estimate component costs and capital weights	Complete Ch. 11 practice I
15	Mon, Dec 7	Capital Decisions	WACC in Excel	Build and audit a weighted-cost model	Submit WACC checkpoint
15	Wed, Dec 9	Capital Decisions	NPV, IRR, and capital budgeting	Build an Excel decision model and compare decision rules	Complete Ch. 11 practice II
15	Fri, Dec 11	Integration	Comprehensive final review	Practice problems, concept map, and exam strategy	Study for the final; complete the Canvas checklist
Finals	Dec. 14-18	Comprehensive final exam · Exact date, time, and room announced by the Registrar and confirmed in Canvas			